

خطة تعلم العربية في أربعمئة يوم

400-Day Modern Standard Arabic Master Roadmap

From a basic foundation to independent, advanced study

Learner profile

Track: Modern Standard Arabic (MSA)

Starting point: basic learner

Daily commitment: 45–60 minutes

Priority: balanced listening, speaking, reading, and writing

Instruction: English support with increasing Arabic immersion

A systematic, assessment-driven course. Complete work directly on printed pages or annotate the PDF, then submit the completed pages or clear photos/scans for evaluation.

How to use this roadmap

This roadmap is the long-range syllabus. The separate 30-day workbook supplies the actual first-month lessons. After each submitted checkpoint, the teacher adjusts the next block: retain the goal, but change pace, explanation style, drill volume, and review content according to demonstrated performance.

Daily 45–60 minute study cycle

- 5–8 min — retrieval review without notes
- 10–12 min — pronunciation and listening/shadowing
- 12–15 min — new language input and guided noticing
- 12–15 min — controlled practice
- 10–12 min — speaking or writing production
- 3–5 min — error log and self-rating

Non-negotiable habits

- Read Arabic aloud every day; accuracy before speed.
- Keep one vocabulary log with the word, a useful phrase, and one original sentence.
- Use transliteration only as temporary support; stop relying on it by Day 30.
- Record a short speaking sample at least twice weekly for self-comparison.
- Never merely reread: retrieve, produce, check, and correct.

The 20-phase syllabus

Phase 1: Foundation reset — Days 1–20

Core syllabus: Sound–letter mapping; connected script; short/long vowels; greetings; nominal sentences; 120 core words

Exit performance: Read fully vocalized phrases; introduce yourself; write short copied and original sentences

Phase 2: Everyday core — Days 21–40

Core syllabus: Present tense; question words; negation; gender/number agreement; home, study, and routine

Exit performance: Hold a 2-minute guided exchange; understand slow, familiar speech

Phase 3: Past and narration — Days 41–60

Core syllabus: Past tense; sequence markers; common broken plurals; family and biography

Exit performance: Tell a short past event in 8–10 connected sentences

Phase 4: Plans and interaction — Days 61–80

Core syllabus: Future markers; imperatives; requests; directions; shopping and services

Exit performance: Complete practical role-plays and follow multi-step directions

Phase 5: Sentence expansion — Days 81–100

Core syllabus: Idafa; object pronouns; relative clauses; connectors; description

Exit performance: Read and write a coherent 120-word profile or description

Phase 6: Case awareness — Days 101–120

Core syllabus: Core nominative/accusative/genitive patterns; sound plurals; dual; formal reading

Exit performance: Recognize high-frequency endings without over-focusing on full inflection

Phase 7: Media foundations — Days 121–140

Core syllabus: Headlines; dates; numbers; weather; public information; listening for gist

Exit performance: Summarize a short learner news item orally and in writing

Phase 8: Verb system I — Days 141–160

Core syllabus: Derived forms II–IV; transitivity; verbal nouns; root-pattern awareness

Exit performance: Infer meaning families and use high-frequency derived verbs

Phase 9: Opinions and reasons — Days 161–180

Core syllabus: Comparatives; because/therefore/although; agreement and disagreement

Exit performance: Sustain a structured 4-minute discussion on familiar topics

Phase 10: Mid-course consolidation — Days 181–200

Core syllabus: Spiral review; pronunciation repair; fluency routines; integrated project

Exit performance: Reach strong A2 / emerging B1 performance on internal benchmark

Phase 11: Verb system II — Days 201–220

Core syllabus: Derived forms V–X; active/passive participles; weak verb families

Exit performance: Decode unfamiliar vocabulary through roots and patterns

Phase 12: Complex grammar — Days 221–240

Core syllabus: Kana and sisters; inna and sisters; conditionals; exception; emphasis

Exit performance: Read adapted essays and produce accurate multi-clause sentences

Phase 13: Academic literacy — Days 241–260

Core syllabus: Paragraph structure; definition; classification; cause/effect; note-taking

Exit performance: Write a 200-word organized explanatory text

Phase 14: Authentic listening — Days 261–280

Core syllabus: Interviews and reports; reduced cues; inference; structured note-taking

Exit performance: Understand the main points of clear standard broadcasts

Phase 15: Literature bridge — Days 281–300

Core syllabus: Short stories; imagery; register; selected classical features

Exit performance: Analyze and discuss an accessible literary passage

Phase 16: Formal communication — Days 301–320

Core syllabus: Presentations; email; reports; summaries; polite formal interaction

Exit performance: Deliver a 6–8 minute prepared presentation with questions

Phase 17: Advanced syntax — Days 321–340

Core syllabus: Passive; circumstantial clauses; absolute object; specification; cohesion

Exit performance: Parse and produce sophisticated formal sentences

Phase 18: Argumentation — Days 341–360

Core syllabus: Claims, evidence, counterarguments, hedging, rhetorical organization

Exit performance: Write and defend a 350-word position essay

Phase 19: Independent comprehension — Days 361–380

Core syllabus: Authentic articles, lectures, podcasts; vocabulary autonomy

Exit performance: Work independently with level-appropriate authentic materials

Phase 20: Capstone and transition — Days 381–400

Core syllabus: Portfolio revision; weak-area clinics; mock proficiency tasks; learning plan

Exit performance: Demonstrate balanced B1+/B2-oriented performance and a sustainable next plan

Assessment and adaptation system

Checkpoint schedule

Daily: 3-item retrieval check and confidence score

Every 7 days: integrated quiz plus error analysis

Every 20 days: phase performance task

Days 100, 200, 300, and 400: cumulative benchmark and portfolio review

Observed result	Instructional response
Below 70% accuracy	Pause new grammar; reteach with smaller steps, more examples, and 2 days of spaced repair.
70–84% accuracy	Continue at planned pace; add targeted retrieval for the two weakest categories.
85–94% accuracy	Continue; reduce repetitive drills and increase open-ended speaking and writing.
95%+ twice	Compact review; add authentic input, faster listening, and richer production.
Speaking lags reading	Use shadowing, timed retells, substitution drills, and shorter but more frequent recordings.
Reading lags speaking	Increase vowel-pattern work, graded reading, phrase chunking, and timed rereading.
Same error recurs 3 times	Create a micro-lesson: contrast, guided discrimination, production, delayed retest.

Skill targets by Day 400

- Listening: follow the main ideas and important details of clear MSA talks, reports, and instructional content.
- Speaking: present, narrate, explain, and defend an opinion with connected language and repair strategies.
- Reading: independently process articles, essays, and accessible literature using root-pattern and context strategies.
- Writing: produce organized summaries, reports, narratives, and arguments with controlled formal grammar.
- Language knowledge: command high-frequency morphology and syntax while using dictionaries and corpora intelligently.

Portfolio evidence

- Monthly speaking sample on the same prompt for longitudinal comparison.
- One revised writing piece per phase, preserving first draft and corrections.
- Vocabulary and error logs reviewed every 20 days.
- Benchmark score sheet with separate listening, speaking, reading, writing, grammar, and vocabulary results.

400-day phase tracker

Phase	Dates	Score / 100	Main repair target	Teacher decision
1	Days 1–20			
2	Days 21–40			
3	Days 41–60			
4	Days 61–80			
5	Days 81–100			
6	Days 101–120			
7	Days 121–140			
8	Days 141–160			
9	Days 161–180			
10	Days 181–200			
11	Days 201–220			
12	Days 221–240			
13	Days 241–260			
14	Days 261–280			
15	Days 281–300			
16	Days 301–320			
17	Days 321–340			
18	Days 341–360			
19	Days 361–380			
20	Days 381–400			

This syllabus is demanding but flexible. Advancement is based on evidence, not calendar completion alone. If a checkpoint shows weak retention, repair days replace new content; they do not merely add extra workload.